as its characteristic cultural *cimarronaje* at work from the time of the Haitian Revolution until Cuban Culture and History today."[26] Thus "while Cuban rappers build networks with U.S. rappers based on race and marginality that transcend national affiliations, they simultaneously generate a critique of global capitalism that allows them to collaborate with the Cuban state."[27]

Annelise Wunderlich believes that the increased salience of racial inequality in the Special Period is one of the reasons the Black Pride message in U.S. hip hop has reached such a receptive audience in Cuba. The Cuban rappers she studied "look up to Malcom X, Mumia Abu-Jamal, Nelson Mandela, and other black icons," and they sought out exiled Black Liberation Army member Nehanda Abiodun to teach them about black history. Meanwhile, "Cuban hip hop has become the darling of the American underground rap scene. Socially conscious rappers … have come to the island in search of what many consider the pure essence of hip hop."[28]

Sport

The revolutionary government made sport central to its domestic and foreign policy. Sport was integral to education and to equalizing opportunity in society. It was also a key element of Cuba's international projection. In some ways, the success of the socialist Revolution was pegged to the success of its athletes. Athletic achievements would illustrate the potentials unleashed and fostered by socialism. Athletes, write Paula Pettavino and Geralyn Pye in their study of sport in Cuba, serve as "revolutionary role models and as sources of national pride."[29]

The Cuban government initiated a national sports program in 1961, using the slogan "el deporte es salud" – sport is health. Physical education programs were implemented in all schools – beginning with preschool – under the auspices of the new Institute for Sports, Physical Education, and Recreation (INDER). Specialized sports schools were established at the secondary school level for children who showed particular talent, where, in addition to the normal curriculum, teens were